

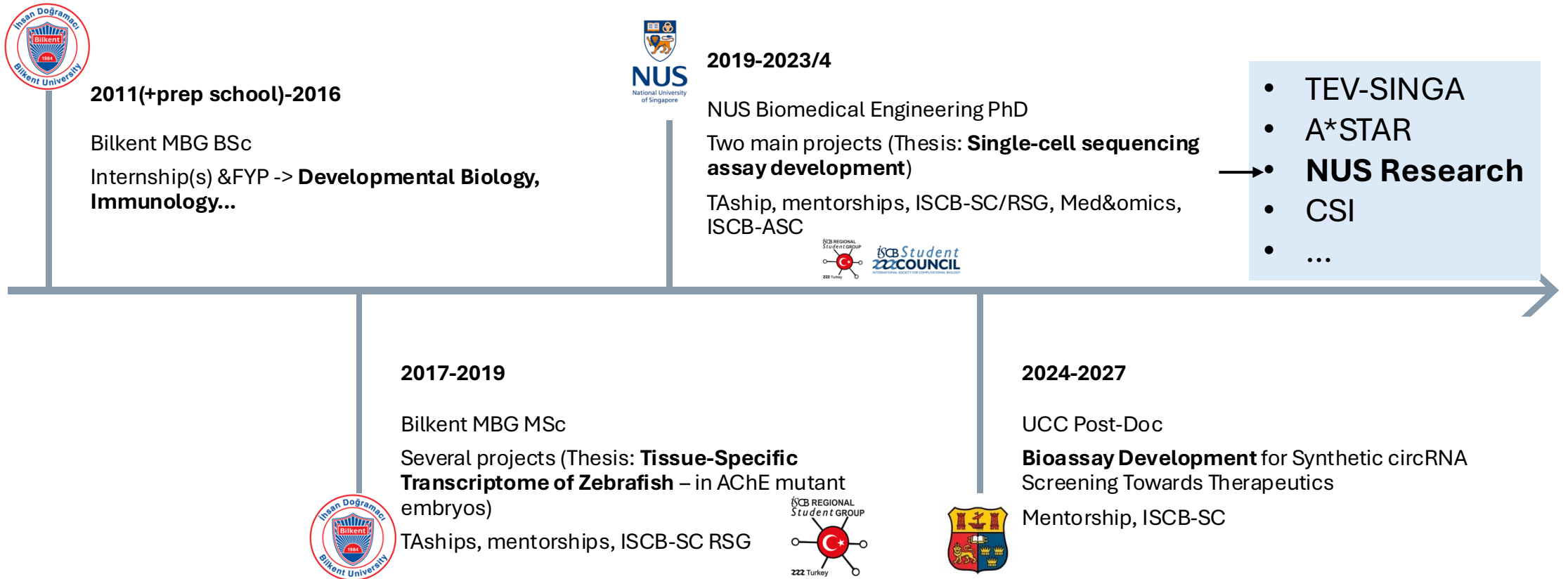


BilGenT

To Master's and Beyond

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2026

Simplified Career Trajectory



How to (Not to/) Choose An Advisor/Lab

A few points to consider:

- Working hours
 - Micromanagement
 - Time management
- Meetings
 - Mentoring
 - Communication
- Project Management Style
 - Collaborations
 - Intellectual freedom
 - Networking/dissemination opportunities
 - Funding and budget
- General Lab Environment
 - Lab culture/Flexibility and diversity
 - Publications/authorship
 - Favouritism
 - Diverse career paths
- Personal queries
 - Work-life balance

MARRIAGE vs. The Ph.D.		
		
	<u>Marriage</u>	<u>Ph.D.</u>
Typical Length:	7.5 years	7 years
Begins with:	A proposal	A thesis proposal
Culminates in a ceremony where you walk down an aisle dressed in a gown:	✓	✓
Usually entered into by:	Foolish young people in love	Foolish young people without a job
50% end in:	Bitter divorce	Bitter remorse
Involves exchange of:	Vows	Know-how
Until death do you part?	If you're lucky	If you're lazy

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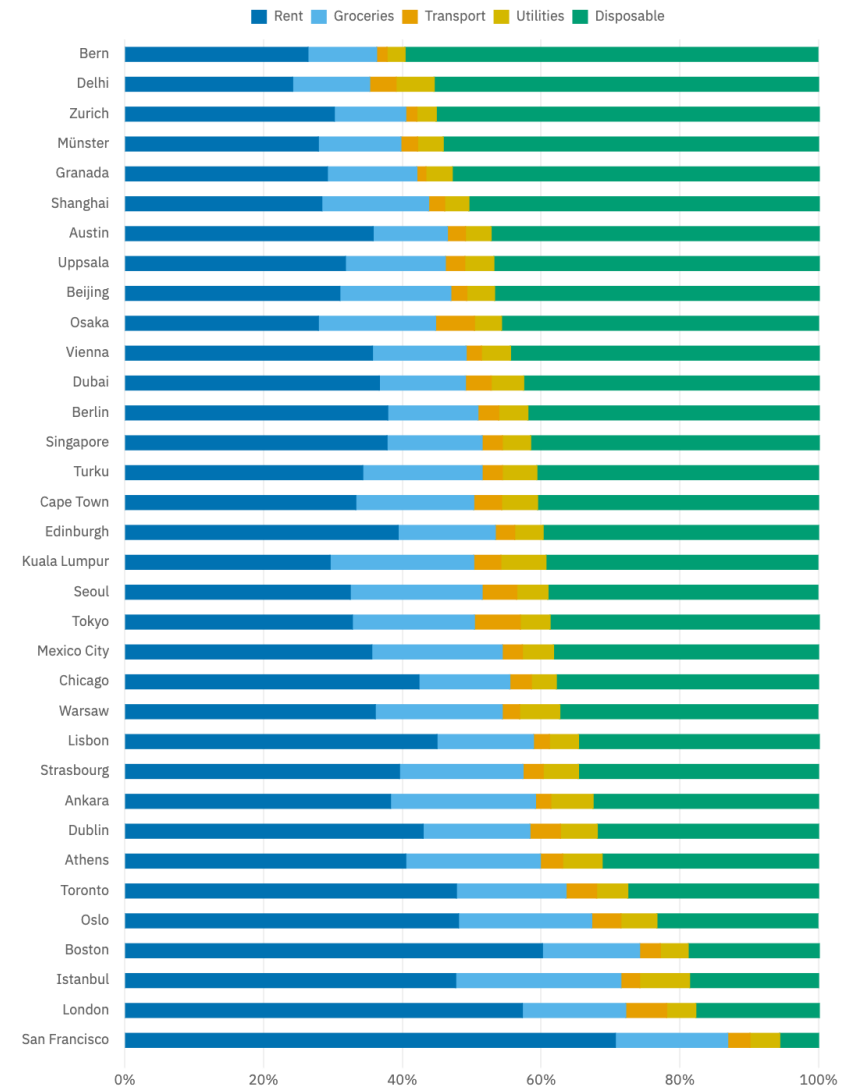
- ➔ Prior internship/RA (if possible)
- ➔ Alumni
- ➔ Publication records
- ➔ Diversity of the team/department
- ➔ Collaboration/networking opportunities
- ➔ Department-level support and groups
- ➔ Facilities available/Infrastructure

What Else to Consider for the Abroad?

- ➔ Gaining new scientific skills
- ➔ Experience, travel and culture
- ➔ Broadening the collaborations and network
- ➔ Thinking strategic as a career investment

- Relocation costs
- Salary vs. cost of living
- Housing availability and accommodation cost
- Expenditure (e.g., transport, groceries, utilities)
- Insurance and Healthcare cost
- Residence renewal and visa issues
- Purchasing power and inflation
- Overall inclusion in the country
- (*perhaps*) Job opportunities afterwards

Scaled cost of living in each selected location based on the PhD salary



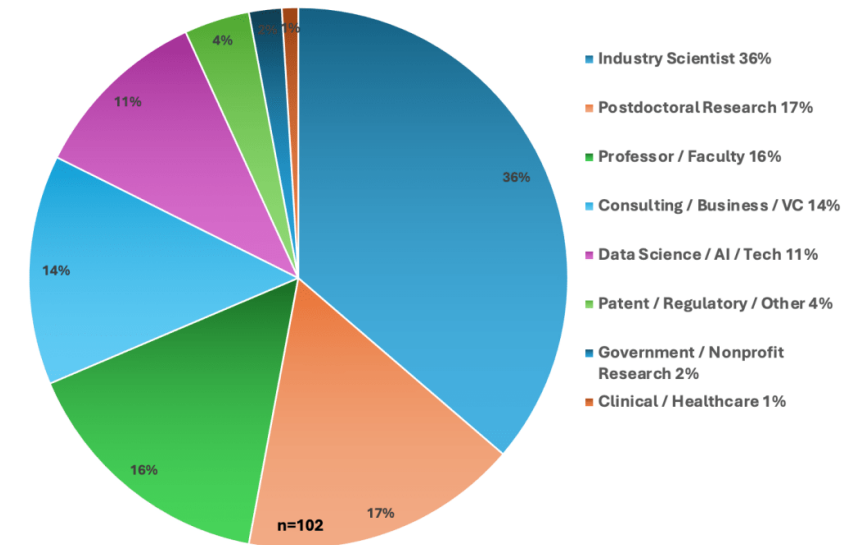
Start Early About Career Goals

0. DO YOU REALLY NEED/WANT PhD?



Nature Reviews | Molecular Cell Biology

Position Types of CSB PhD Graduates (2009–2026)



<https://csbphd.mit.edu/csb-career-outcomes/>

1. Academic positions are limited
2. PhD training is more than what you think
3. There are other ways of make impactful contribution to society
4. *Might have personal reasons such as salary expectations, better work-life balance, health reasons*

How to Build Professional Presence Online?

My all-time fav: Ming (Tommy) Tang (a.k.a. crazyhottommy)

As an academic, the must-haves:

- **ORCID**



- Research contributions and work experience

- **Google Scholar**



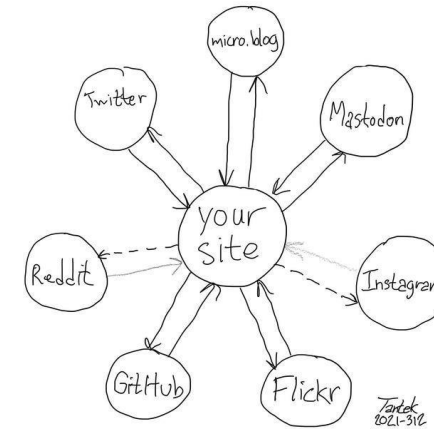
- From posters, thesis and books to articles

- **GitHub**



- Zenodo or other alternatives
- For codes/scripts and data analysis

- **Institutional pages** (*if available*)



<https://blog.stephenturner.us/p/technical-blogging>

Some alternatives:

- **Substack** for personal blogging
- **Medium** for partner blogging programs
- **YouTube** for long videos
- **Tiktok** or **Instagram** for short videos
- **Bluesky**, **Twitter** or **Mastodon** for connecting and short discussions
- **LinkedIn** for professional connections and queries
- **Discord** for stream coding
- **Reddit** or **StackOverflow** for technical discussions
- **Spotify** for podcasts

Community Involvement for Mental Health

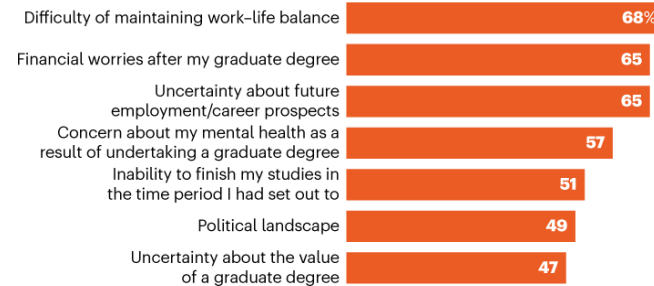


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CHALLENGES AND OBSTACLES

Nature's survey of graduate students highlights the rewards and challenges of scientific training. Despite financial struggles, long work hours and widespread mental-health issues, the majority of respondents are still satisfied with their programmes.

What concerns have you had since you started your graduate degree?

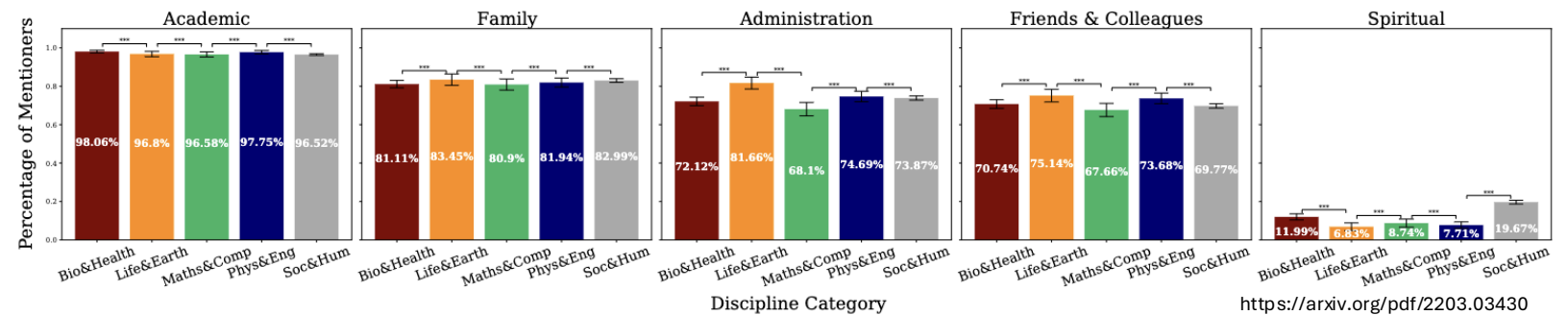


<https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-022-03394-0>

Good academic support group is associated with better well-being during PhD

Number one rule of academia: your colleagues are your allies, not your rivals

So, the **smart networking starts with your academic peer groups!**



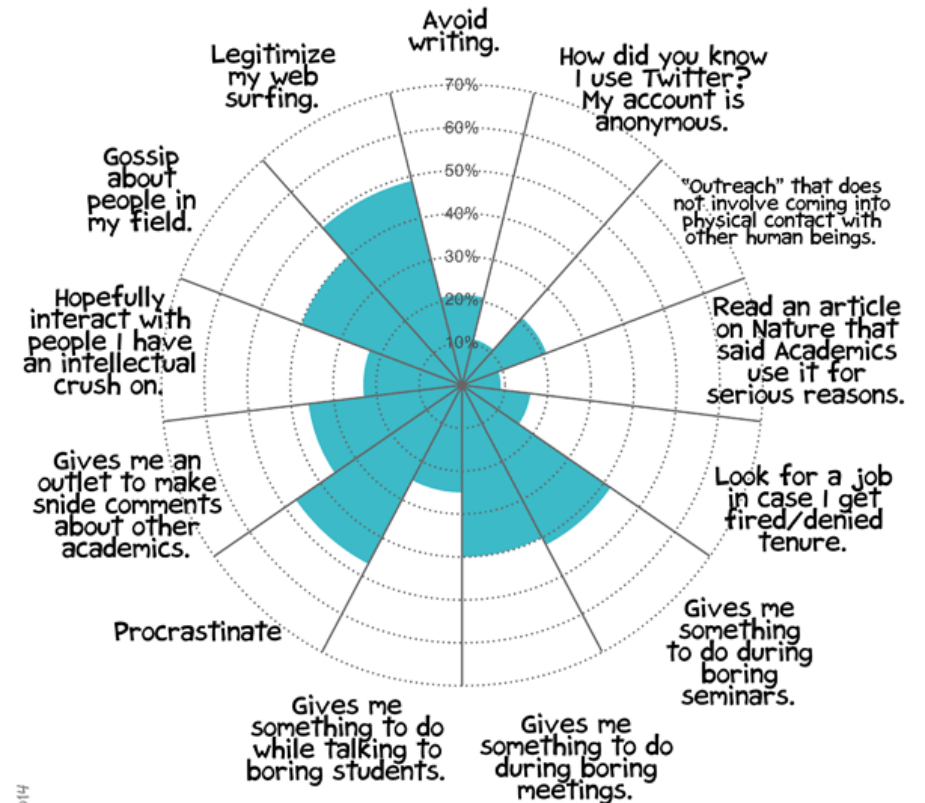
<https://arxiv.org/pdf/2203.03430>

The age of cold email might be dead with AI, so what else you can do

Smart Networking Authenticity

- Genuine, mutual professional networking strategy
 - ~~Not a cold message to get hired~~
 - Meet-ups, groups or communities to connect
 - Cultivate strong and trustful digital presence
 - Pay-it-forward mindset
 - Stay targeted
 - Focusing on advice rather than employment
 - Use social media wisely to find and connect people
- **Informal interviews**
 - Gain industry&role insights
 - Build network proactively
 - Chance to introduce yourself

Why Academics *REALLY* Use Social Media



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Original graph from: nature.com/news/online-collaboration-scientists-and-the-social-network-1.15711

THANKS